

REPARATION

THE ROAD TO PEACE

The purpose of our program for dealing with Germany should be peace. That should be the only purpose. All the peoples of the earth have a right to expect that their sacrifices in this war have earned them title to a world in which another generation of youth will not have to be maimed and die in the defense of human freedom.

The first step toward that peace must be an end once and for all to the menace of German aggression. If our children and our grandchildren will not have to fight through the horrors which men of my generation have faced twice, we must remove the means of German aggression.

A realistic program consists, in its simplest terms, of depriving Germany of all heavy industries. The reason for selecting heavy industries is that with them Germany can quickly and terribly convert once more to war. Without them, no matter how savage her aggressive aims may be, she cannot make war.

The hopes of mankind rest upon the peace which we must now begin to build out of the wreckage of lives and cities and nations. It is an awesome, but an inspiring task. It is for us, the living, to carry forward in the spirit of Lincoln that our hallowed dead shall not have died in vain. All our hopes and yearnings for peace will fade and die unless we build upon a firm foundation, the foundation of an assured end to German aggression.

The elimination of German heavy industry is no hate campaign. The world has seen enough of hatred, and we have no need to adopt the policy of our enemies. Nor is the program a complete panacea for peace. But it is the essential preliminary to peace and to